smart contract. Smart contracts run in a sandbox (EVM in Ethereum) controlled by the blockchain infrastructure so that all the participants have consistent outcomes when a smart contract function executes.

The web3 API is an interface to the underlying blockchain services. Even for simple conversion from ether to wei and hexadecimal numbers to display numbers, you use the web3 (utils) library function because the operations have to be consistent among all participants.

You don’t write thousands of lines of code or use composition and inheritance of other pieces of code in the smart contract. The blockchain infrastructure provides many services that are invoked with appropriate calls from the application.

Finally, did you realize that all the entities--such as the organizer, smart contract, worker, and verifier--can be autonomous machines and software programs, automatically cleaning up the earth and collecting cryptopayments for the work? (What? No humans in the loop?)

7.6 Best practices

Here are some best practices for payment channels:

- Examine traditional solutions before resorting to blockchain solutions. The conventional banking system may work fine for many of your daily needs, such as bill-paying for your credit card expenses. Where a traditional solution exists, use it instead of overfitting a blockchain solution.